

PRD: Streamlined Onboarding Flow for Hiring Platforms

Teardown link - [Onboarding Teardown](#)

1. Problem Statement

Long, multi-step onboarding (10+ screens, including two separate verification channels) creates compounding drop-off before users reach any real value. Each additional step beyond ~5 tends to reduce completion by roughly 10–15%, and requiring two verification channels (e.g., SMS *and* email) forces a context-switch mid-flow that adds friction — particularly for less tech-native users. Users who do push through often rush the remaining fields out of fatigue ("satisficing"), leaving the platform with an account but a shallow, low-quality profile ("profile debt") that limits downstream matching.

2. Goal

Reduce onboarding drop-off and improve profile data quality/completeness, without weakening the identity trust a hiring marketplace depends on.

3. Success Metrics

- **North Star:** Onboarding completion rate (Get Started click → Dashboard reached, same session)
- **Supporting:**
 - Verification success rate (single channel)
 - Median time to complete onboarding
 - Profile completeness at Day 0 and Day 7
 - Step-level drop-off rate

4. Proposed Solution

- Cut total onboarding steps (target: reduce by 3–4 vs. current baseline)
- Move to **one primary verification channel** (e.g., phone/SMS); keep the second channel (email) as an optional recovery method, not a blocking step
- Trim upfront profiling questions to the minimum needed for baseline matching; defer the rest
- Add a **"Complete later"** option on profiling steps, with a visible progress indicator
- Surface a preview of value (e.g., dashboard insights, sample matches) *before* asking users to finish remaining profile fields, to motivate completion rather than force it

5. Scope

In scope: signup, verification, and profiling steps; progress indicator; skip/"complete later" logic; post-onboarding nudges to close profile gaps.

Out of scope: dashboard visual redesign, matching/recommendation algorithm changes, new verification methods (e.g., ID upload).

6. Key Requirements

- New users verify through a single channel — no forced app-switching mid-signup.
- Users can skip optional profiling fields and complete them later without losing progress.
- Users with incomplete profiles get a reminder nudge (in-app + email/push) post-dashboard.
- Every onboarding screen has step-level drop-off tracking so impact can be measured.

7. Risks & Assumptions

- **Assumption:** phone verification is reliably deliverable across target markets; may need email-primary fallback in specific geographies.
- **Risk:** relaxing upfront verification could raise fake/duplicate signups — mitigate with backend fraud checks rather than more upfront friction.
- **Risk:** "Complete later" could hurt long-term profile completeness if nudges are weak — needs its own success metric and iteration loop.

8. Rollout Plan

1. **A/B test** shortened flow (single verification + reduced profiling) vs. current flow on a subset of new signups.
2. **Monitor** completion rate, verification success rate, and Day-7 profile completeness for 2–3 sprints.
3. **Full rollout** if completion improves without a meaningful rise in fraud/spam signals.